

He started sitting in the same spot as me now.
Not next to me – across. Diagonal.
Close enough to hear me write.

He asked me if I was working on anything “new.”
I lied and said no.
I watched him write something in his own notebook after I said that.

I don’t think he believes me.
I don’t think he cares.

He isn’t stealing ideas.
He’s stealing cadence.

And once he gets the tone right, the content doesn’t matter.

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